

Reading Journal VII - SEIII

Reading Journal 7

For the remaining Reading Journals there will be three different options, or "tracks". Remember that you **only have to choose one track**. Your options are:

1. **Track One: Extensive Reading - Fiction.** Please choose a new work of fiction. It could be a novel OR a series of short stories. The novel can be any genre (adventure, mystery, historical fiction, romance, sci-fi, classic literature, etc. Obviously, your choice(s) must be in English.

2. **Track Two: Extensive Reading - Non-Fiction.** Please choose work of non-fiction. It could be a book OR a series of academic articles. The book can be about any subject (history, science, geography, philosophy, etc.) Obviously, your choice(s) must be in English.

3. **Track Three - Textbook.** You can also choose to complete readings from our textbook. These should be readings we HAVE NOT done in class. Narrow down the list to four text passages.

Please write a REFLECTION about what you read. Include a brief summary of the main points along with your thoughts/observations/feelings. What did you learn? What was interesting about this reading? (150 words)

Due Sunday, November 30th by 21:00.

Track II

- **Title:** Being Logical: A Guide to Good Thinking
- **Author:** D. Q. McInerney
- **Reflection:**

This book is tiny, plain-spoken and easy-to-understand, but still explains how logic works briefly, clearly and effectively. The book is divided into five parts—preparing the mind for logic, basic principles, the language of argument, sources of illogical thinking, and the principal forms of fallacies, which makes the structure clear and formal. Besides, what I learned most was to define terms before arguing, and to check whether the conclusion follows all the premises. And the fallacies—ad hominem, straw man, false dilemma, and post hoc are also extremely common on our daily life. I also noticed the opening reminder that logical thinking begins with a mindset—attention, humility, and a focus on facts—not with symbols. Nevertheless, I think my words will become more and more logical and persuasive since I finished this book.